

[PAGE 1: COVER]

The Philippines E-Invoicing Readiness Playbook 2026

From CAS to EIS: the full compliance journey, from understanding the mandate to issuing your first structured invoice.

A field guide for CFOs, Tax Heads, and CIOs at large taxpayers and enterprises in scope for Wave 1. It maps the statutory foundation, who is covered, the registration path, and what a compliant go-live actually requires under RR 11-2025.

31 Dec 2026 Wave 1 deadline: Large Taxpayers (LTS-registered), EOPT-classified Large Taxpayers, e-commerce, and CAS/CBA users	6 to 10 weeks CAS plus EIS onboarding: sequential, not parallel	10 years Mandatory invoice archival and retrieval period	50 to 100% One-time setup-cost deduction under CREATE MORE
--	---	--	--

Prepared by ClearTax - The e-invoicing infrastructure behind 1B+ invoices a year across 50+ tax regimes, including Philippine EIS.

[PAGE 2: EXECUTIVE SUMMARY AND WHY IT MATTERS]

Eyebrow: Where the Philippines stands

Headline: A live mandate, a 6-to-10-week registration clock, and a partner-shaped problem

From 31 December 2026, every invoice you issue must reach the BIR as a signed, validated JSON payload, or it does not legally exist. The Bureau of Internal Revenue (BIR) is moving invoicing from a paper record into a data stream, and your ERP is now the point of compliance.

Under **Revenue Regulations No. 11-2025**, covered taxpayers must issue structured **JSON invoices signed with a JWS/RS256 digital signature** from BIR-registered software, and report that same data to the BIR's Electronic Invoicing System (EIS). A PDF is not an e-invoice.

‘An emailed invoice is not an e-invoice. A scanned copy is not an e-invoice.’

The Wave 1 issuance deadline is **31 December 2026** for Large Taxpayers, e-commerce, and any enterprise on a Computerised Accounting System (CAS/CBA). Because registration with the BIR is sequential and takes **six to ten weeks**, the practical window to start is now. This playbook walks the full journey: the law behind the mandate, who is in scope, the two-step registration path from CAS to EIS, and what a compliant implementation demands of your ERP and your teams.

The core misconception: Many enterprises believe they already do e-invoicing because their invoices are digital. They do not. Generating a PDF from your ERP and emailing it is digitising paper, not structured e-invoicing. Under RR 11-2025, that gap becomes non-compliance on 31 December 2026.

Eyebrow: Why this matters now

Headline: Four ways the mandate hits your P&L, not just your compliance calendar

You lose input VAT the moment a payload fails validation. A malformed JSON is not a "corrected later" event. The invoice is legally void, your buyer cannot claim 12% input VAT, and repeat offenders are named on the BIR non-compliance list.	One system error, three separate penalties. Failure to issue, failure to transmit, and failure to maintain books are stacked offences under NIRC §§264 and 264-A. PHP 1,000 to PHP 50,000 per offence plus 2-to-4 years imprisonment exposure for responsible officers. One bad payload can trigger all three at once.
Your VAT return is now matched against your invoices in real time. The BIR cross-references 2550Q filings against EIS-transmitted data automatically. A mismatch you would have caught in a	The mandate pays back, but only if you claim it in the setup year. CREATE MORE grants a one-time additional deduction on your e-invoicing setup costs: 100% for micro and small, 50% for medium

year-end reconciliation becomes an audit letter in weeks, and it lands on the CFO's desk, not the tax manager's.

and large. Deferred spend means a deferred deduction, and the incentive is a one-time credit, not a recurring one.

[PAGE 3: THE REGULATORY FOUNDATION]

Eyebrow: How the law got here

Headline: From NIRC Section 237 to the EIS mandate

The e-invoicing rule did not appear overnight. It is the implementation of a decade of statutory groundwork, each layer expanding what the BIR can require of taxpayers.

[Design cue: Timeline rows, year label on the left with a blue node, description on the right.]

● 2018 TRAIN Law	NIRC §237 & §237-A — the legal basis The TRAIN Law (RA 10963) amended the Tax Code to introduce §237-A, requiring e-receipts/e-invoices and electronic sales-data reporting for large taxpayers, exporters, and e-commerce — the seed of today's EIS.
● 2022 RR 8-2022	EIS pilot & the transmission framework RR 8-2022 operationalised §§237/237-A: CAS registration, sales-data transmission, and the pilot Electronic Invoicing/Receipting System. It defines the Wave 2 exporter cohort still awaiting its live date.
● 2024 EOPT - RA 11976	Ease of Paying Taxes — documents change EOPT made the Sales Invoice the primary VAT document and deprecated the Official Receipt for services (now the Service Billing). It also redefined taxpayer size classes used to determine who is a "large taxpayer."
● Nov 2024 CREATE MORE - RA 12066	The mandate's engine — and its incentive CREATE MORE made structured e-invoicing and electronic sales reporting mandatory, and attached the one-time setup-cost deduction (100% micro/small, 50% medium/large).

I

2018 — TRAIN Law: NIRC Section 237 and 237-A, the legal basis. The TRAIN Law (RA 10963) amended the Tax Code to introduce Section 237-A, requiring e-receipts and e-invoices and electronic sales-data reporting for large taxpayers, exporters, and e-commerce. This was the seed of today's EIS.

2022 — RR 8-2022: EIS pilot and the transmission framework. RR 8-2022 operationalised Sections 237 and 237-A: CAS registration, sales-data transmission, and the pilot Electronic Invoicing/Receipting System. It defines the Wave 2 exporter cohort still awaiting its live date.

2024 — EOPT, RA 11976: Ease of Paying Taxes, documents change. EOPT made the Sales Invoice the primary VAT document and deprecated the Official Receipt for services (now the Billing Invoice). It also redefined the taxpayer size classes used to determine who is a "large taxpayer."

Nov 2024 — CREATE MORE, RA 12066: the mandate's engine and its incentive. CREATE MORE made structured e-invoicing and electronic sales reporting mandatory, and attached the one-time setup-cost deduction (100% micro and small, 50% medium and large).

2025 to 2026 — RR 11-2025 and RR 26-2025: the operative rules and the deadline. RR 11-2025 (27 Feb 2025) set scope, JSON format, and incentives. RR 26-2025 extended Wave 1 issuance to 31 December 2026. ESRS live reporting (the 3-day transmission window) activates under a separate, later regulation.

[Design cue: Section label, then a four-column table with a navy header row.]

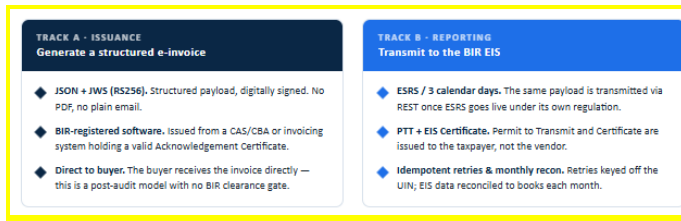
Are you in scope? Taxpayer-segment mapping (EOPT / RR 8-2024 classes)

Segment	Annual gross sales	Wave 1 status	What triggers coverage
Micro	Below PHP 3 million	Exempt (may opt in)	Voluntary, 100% deduction if adopted
Small	PHP 3M to below PHP 20M	Covered	e-commerce / online seller, or CAS/CBA use
Medium	PHP 20M to below PHP 1B	Covered	CAS/CBA or invoicing software in use
Large	PHP 1 billion and above	Covered, Wave 1	LTS registration, EOPT-classified Large Taxpayers, e-commerce, or CAS/CBA

Coverage applies regardless of revenue size where CAS/CBA or invoicing software is in use, because the presence of the system itself triggers the rule. **If any one branch is in scope, every location under that TIN must comply.** Moreover, exemption to Micro segment applies specifically to Sections 3(A)(1), 3(A)(4), 3(A)(5)(i)–(iv)) in Revenue Regulation. If a Micro Taxpayer is an LTS taxpayer or uses CAS/CBA, the interplay is not simply "exempt". Exporters and incentive-availing RBEs (Wave 2) join once the BIR's storing-and-processing system is live, under a separate regulation.

[PAGE 4: THE READINESS JOURNEY, CAS TO EIS]

[Design cue: Blue eyebrow, serif headline. Two side-by-side track cards: Track A on a navy header, Track B on a blue header.]



1

Eyebrow: Two tracks you cannot separate

Headline: What the mandate puts on every covered taxpayer

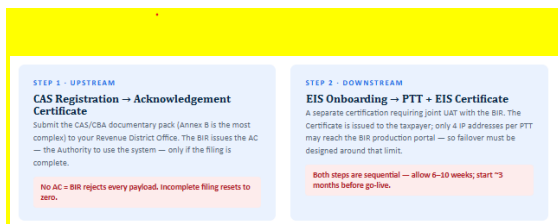
Track A, Issuance: generate a structured e-invoice

- JSON plus JWS (RS256). Structured payload, digitally signed. No PDF, no plain email.
- BIR-registered software. Issued from a CAS/CBA or invoicing system holding a valid Acknowledgement Certificate.
- Direct to buyer. The buyer receives the invoice directly. This is a post-audit model with no BIR clearance gate.

Track B, Reporting: transmit to the BIR EIS

- ESRS, 3 calendar days (activates under a separate, later regulation). The same payload is transmitted via REST once ESRS goes live under its own regulation.
- PTT plus EIS Certificate. Permit to Transmit and Certificate are issued to the taxpayer, not the vendor.
- Idempotent retries and monthly reconciliation. Retries keyed off the UIN; EIS data reconciled to books each month.

[Design cue: Eyebrow, then two step cards on a light-blue tint, each ending in a red warning strip.]



1

Eyebrow: Before you can invoice, two sequential BIR certifications

Step 1, Upstream: CAS Registration to Acknowledgement Certificate. Submit the CAS/CBA documentary pack (Annex B is the most complex) to your Revenue District Office. The BIR issues the AC, the authority to use the system, only if the filing is complete. *Warning strip: No AC means the BIR rejects every payload. Incomplete filing resets to zero.*

Step 2, Downstream: EIS Onboarding to PTT plus EIS Certificate. A separate certification requiring joint UAT with the BIR. The Certificate is issued to the taxpayer; only 4 IP addresses per PTT may reach the BIR production portal, so failover must be designed around that limit. *Warning strip: Both steps are sequential. Allow 6 to 10 weeks; start about 3 months before go-live.*

[Design cue: Eyebrow, then a 3x2 grid of bordered field cards.]

4 Discount Types Senior Citizen, PWD, Regular, Special — each a separate mandatory JSON field, not one generic discount.	4 Withholding Buckets Income Tax, CWT, Business Tax, BPT — each a distinct line item. A single field triggers CWT audit exposure.	Dual Currency Transaction currency + PHP equivalent on every invoice, even for purely-PHP sales.
TIN + Branch Code 9-digit TIN plus the mandatory branch code per entity. Branch 0000 is head office; each branch registers.	Freight Fields Airway Bill and Bill of Lading numbers and dates — required on all export invoices, absent from standard setups.	BIR Serial Range Invoice series registered with the BIR before first use. Gaps or backdating trigger immediate audit flags.

Eyebrow: The technical gap, six fields standard ERPs cannot produce out of the box

- **4 Discount Types:** Senior Citizen, PWD, Regular, Special. Each is a separate mandatory JSON field, not one generic discount.
- **4 Withholding Buckets:** Income Tax, CWT, Business Tax, BPT. Each is a distinct line item. A single field triggers CWT audit exposure.
- **Dual Currency:** When the transaction currency is not PHP, both the foreign currency amount (ForexAmt) and the PHP equivalent are required.
- **TIN plus Branch Code:** 9-digit TIN plus the mandatory branch code per entity. Branch 0000 is head office; each branch registers.
- **Freight Fields:** Airway Bill and Bill of Lading numbers and dates, required on all export invoices, absent from standard setups.
- **BIR Serial Range:** Invoice series registered with the BIR before first use. Gaps or backdating trigger immediate audit flags.

[Design cue: Navy callout box with a large blue "4 to 6 months" number on the left.]

4–6 months

A realistic large-enterprise timeline from kickoff to go-live — gap assessment, ERP integration, testing and UAT with the BIR sit on top of the 6–10 week registration. **Document types have already changed:** issuing an Official Receipt for services is non-compliant today; the Service Billing replaces it, and every Credit/Debit Note must reference the original invoice UIN.

4 to 6 months: A realistic timeline for a large enterprise from kickoff to go-live. Gap assessment, ERP integration, testing, and UAT with the BIR sit on top of the 6 to 10 week registration. Document types have already changed: issuing an Official Receipt for services is non-compliant today; the Billing invoice replaces it, and every Credit or Debit Note must reference the original invoice UIN.

Enterprises going in alone typically hit the six-field ERP gap, the 9-document AC pack, and the PTT slot limit as three separate escalations. ClearTax collapses them into one workflow. Read the next section.

[PAGE 5: WHY CLEARTAX]

[Design cue: Deep navy background. Serif headline with "ClearTax closes." in bright blue.]

Every gap the BIR mandate exposes, ClearTax closes.

Purpose-built for tax compliance — 1B+ invoices a year, 50+ countries live, 5,000+ enterprise clients. Built for the scale and regulatory specificity of the Philippines mandate, not retrofitted onto a generic e-invoicing tool.

▶ WITHOUT A PURPOSE-BUILT PARTNER

Your ERP cannot produce BIR-specific fields — every malformed payload is rejected and no invoice legally exists.

The 9-document AC pack must be complete before a single invoice issues — Annex B is the hardest.

A single outage inside the transmission window pushes invoices past the deadline — even correctly issued ones.

Only 4 IP addresses per PTT reach the BIR portal — self-managed transmission risks slot exhaustion.

✓ WITH CLEARTAX

All six BIR field sets auto-filled from existing ERP data. Zero custom development required.

ClearTax guides every document and produces Annex B on your behalf; AC submission managed end-to-end.

Idempotent auto-retry keyed off the UIN — the same invoice ID on every retry, no duplicates to the BIR.

ClearTax manages transmission within your registered PTT slots — fully managed infrastructure.

◆ Regulatory Assurance

In-house PH tax team tracks every RR change, 4x faster go-live with the AI integration agent, and zero IT effort for mandate upgrades post go-live.

◆ Performance at Scale

Auto-healing and deep validation to prevent failures, capacity for up to 10k invoices/second, and a 99.9% uptime SLA.

◆ Delivery & Defence

Continuous books-to-EIS reconciliation, BIR acknowledgment token on every invoice, and 10-year retention contractually committed.

Independently audited & PH-aligned: SOC 2 Type II - ISO 27001:2022 - ISO 22301:2019 - VAPT by independent third party - Philippines Data Privacy Act (RA 10173) aligned - AES-256 encryption at rest - Multi-AZ with local data residency - ON follower does not cross borders.

1

Headline: Every gap the BIR mandate exposes, ClearTax closes.

Intro: Purpose-built for tax compliance: 1B+ invoices a year, 50+ countries live, 5,000+ enterprise clients. Built for the scale and regulatory specificity of the Philippines mandate, not retrofitted onto a generic e-invoicing tool.

[Design cue: Two-column comparison table. Left column "Without a purpose-built partner" in muted red; right column "With ClearTax" in green.]

Without a purpose-built partner	With ClearTax
---------------------------------	---------------

Your ERP cannot produce BIR-specific fields, so every malformed payload is rejected, and no invoice legally exists.	All six BIR field sets auto-filled from existing ERP data. Zero custom development required.
The 9-document AC pack must be complete before a single invoice issues, and Annex B is the hardest.	ClearTax guides every document and produces Annex B on your behalf; AC submission managed end to end.
A single outage inside the transmission window pushes invoices past the deadline, even correctly issued ones.	Idempotent auto-retry keyed off the UIN, the same invoice ID on every retry, no duplicates to the BIR.
Only 4 IP addresses per PTT reach the BIR portal, so self-managed transmission risks slot exhaustion.	ClearTax manages transmission within your registered PTT slots, fully managed infrastructure.

[Design cue: Three assurance cards.]

- **Regulatory Assurance:** In-house PH tax team tracks every RR change; 4x faster go-live with the AI integration agent, and zero IT effort for mandate upgrades post go-live.
- **Performance at Scale:** Auto-healing and deep validation to prevent failures, capacity for up to 10k invoices per second, and a 99.9% uptime SLA.
- **Delivery and Defence:** Continuous books-to-EIS reconciliation, BIR acknowledgement token on every invoice, and 10-year retention contractually committed.

[Design cue: Trust bar set off by thin rules above and below.]

Independently audited and PH-aligned: SOC 2 Type II, ISO 27001:2022, ISO 22301:2019, VAPT by an independent third party, Philippines Data Privacy Act (RA 10173) aligned, AES-256 encryption at rest, Multi-AZ with local data residency, DR failover does not cross borders.

[Design cue: Closing CTA block with a blue button.]

Ready to evaluate your Philippines readiness?

Get a personalised gap assessment, a BIR field-mapping walkthrough, and CAS registration guidance before your Wave 1 clock runs out on 31 December 2026.

[Talk to our expert →](#)

Ready to evaluate your Philippines readiness? Get a personalised gap assessment, a BIR field-mapping walkthrough, and CAS registration guidance before your Wave 1 clock runs out on 31 December 2026.

[Button: Talk to our expert]

